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Starting check: find the next teachable step

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Status: ready to attempt; no answers or completion recorded.

Spend about 20 minutes. No preparation is required. Use a pen and paper; avoid searching or using a calculator on this first attempt so the mentor can see which methods to teach. You may skip any item. Write “not sure” when needed and add a confidence label: **sure / partly sure / guess**.

This is not an IQ test, a school exam, an eligibility check or a forecast of UPSC performance. Ten simple questions cannot measure those things. They give us a few examples of your current reading, arithmetic and civic understanding.

Reading — 3 questions

Read this passage:

> A village has one public well. In summer, the water level falls. The village council proposes fixed collection times and a limit on how much water each household collects. Some residents support the plan because it may reduce waste. Others say families with more members need more water. The council agrees to listen to both groups before deciding. The passage does not tell us whether the plan finally worked.

1. What problem is the council trying to address? Answer in one sentence.
2. Why do some residents object to the same limit for every household?
3. Can we conclude from this passage that the plan solved the problem? Explain using the passage.

Arithmetic and interpreting data — 4 questions

4. You have ₹100 and spend ₹35. How much is left? Show the calculation.
5. A class has 20 learners. One quarter are absent. How many are absent?
6. A ₹200 item is discounted by 10%. What is its new price? Show how you found the discount.
7. A library lent 12 books on Monday, 18 on Tuesday and 15 on Wednesday. How many books were lent altogether, and on which day were the most lent? Both parts matter.

Civic reasoning — 3 questions

You do not need legal terminology. Everyday language is welcome.

8. Why might a school need rules that also apply to its principal, rather than letting the principal do anything?
9. After an election, a new government takes office. Does that automatically mean the country's Constitution disappears? Give your best explanation.
10. Two people dispute whether a public authority followed the law. Which institution is principally responsible for adjudicating legal disputes: the legislature, the executive or the judiciary? If unfamiliar with these words, say so instead of guessing silently.

Record before checking

For each question, record your answer and confidence. For skipped questions write **not attempted**, not "wrong." Note any unfamiliar word. Tell the mentor whether English itself made a question harder; language difficulty and subject knowledge are different teaching needs.

Stop here until you have attempted the questions.

▼ **Open the answer guide only after your attempt**

Reading 1. The village has less available well water in summer / needs to manage limited water fairly. The passage does not say the well has completely dried up. 2. Larger families may need more water than smaller families; the same household limit may not meet different needs. 3. No. The passage says the council will listen and does not report the outcome. "It sounds like a good plan" is an opinion, not evidence that it worked. ### Arithmetic and data 4. ₹100 − ₹35 = **₹65**. 5. One quarter means one of four equal parts: 20 ÷ 4 = **5 learners**. 6. 10% of ₹200 = ₹20; ₹200 − ₹20 = **₹180**. 7. 12 + 18 + 15 = **45 books**; **Tuesday** had the most, with 18. ### Civic reasoning 8. A suitable answer mentions fairness, limits on arbitrary decisions, protecting others or accountability. Example: "Rules stop the principal from punishing someone just because they dislike them." Other sensible explanations can be correct. 9. **No.** A government can change while the constitutional framework continues. Constitutional changes require the applicable constitutional processes; an election result alone does not erase it. 10. **The judiciary**, meaning courts, principally adjudicates legal disputes. The legislature mainly makes laws; the executive mainly carries out laws and administration. There are overlaps and checks that later lessons will explain. ### Use the results to choose teaching, not a label Give each attempted item **1** if correct with the requested reasoning, **0.5** if partly correct, or **0** if incorrect. For Question 7, award 0.5 for each correct part. For Questions 8–9, accept accurate everyday wording. Keep skipped items separate. Feedback is more useful than a total. | Domain | Report | What it helps us choose | | --- | --- | --- | | Reading | points out of 3; attempted count; unfamiliar words | Short passages, main idea, inference and evidence | | Arithmetic/data | points out of 4; attempted count; method errors | Operations → fractions → percentages → tables | | Civic reasoning | points out of 3; attempted count; terms needing explanation | Rules → Constitution → institutions and checks | An unanswered item suggests a useful place to start, not an inability to learn. Even correct answers may need follow-up if guessed. The mentor should ask one similar question using different numbers or a new example before deciding the concept is secure.